

Boston University Questrom School of Business
Graduate Admissions & Financial Aid Office

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March 4, 2026

Michael Sparks
1000 Spring Street
Unit 603
Atlanta, GA 30309
United States

BU ID: U61709016

Dear Michael,

Congratulations! On behalf of the faculty of the Questrom School of Business, I am delighted to offer you admission to the **PhD in Business Economics** program as a full-time student beginning in the Fall 2026 semester. Admission to our program is highly competitive, and you have been selected from a large pool of applicants based on your outstanding academic achievements and potential as a scholar.

As part of your admission offer, we are pleased to provide you with up to five years of funding, including a full tuition scholarship and a stipend. Additional details are outlined in the accompanying funding letter.

The faculty at Questrom includes distinguished scholars whose research is shaping management thinking and practice. Our research centers explore pressing questions facing organizations and society, and we hope you will choose to join our community of scholars. As you consider this opportunity, we encourage you to connect with your admitted program to learn more about your course of study, research opportunities, and other available resources.

To secure your place in the Boston University Questrom School of Business PhD in Business Economics program, please review the information included in the funding letter and sign your Declaration of Intent no later than **April 15, 2026**. Since fellowship funding is limited and highly competitive, failure to submit your confirmation by this deadline will result in the withdrawal of your admission and fellowship offer. If you decide not to accept our offer, kindly notify us as soon as possible so we can extend the opportunity to another candidate.

Once you've submitted your Declaration of Intent, we encourage you to explore our [Admitted Student Website](#) (password: PHDterriers) where you'll find important deadlines, dates, and resources to help you prepare for your transition to Questrom.

Boston University offers a wide range of support and resources for graduate students. You can explore these services at www.bu.edu/grad.

[Submit your Enrollment Decision here.](#)

Michael, we at Boston University salute your achievements, and we look forward to welcoming you to our PhD community. Congratulations again!

Sincerely,
The PhD Admissions Review Team

Graduate Admissions & Financial Aid
Questrom School of Business, Boston University



PhD in Business Economics Stipend Funding Letter

March 4, 2026

This supplemental letter provides important information about the terms and conditions of your PhD in Business Economics funding. It is important for our students to understand their funding and benefits package as well as the work requirements associated with their PhD education. We describe these requirements below.

PhD Funding

PhD in Business Economics students receive five years of funding in exchange for completing the work or training requirements set by your program. This five-year period begins at matriculation and concludes on the final day of Summer Term II in your fifth year in the program, or upon graduation, whichever occurs first. In your first year, the University is pleased to offer you 12 months of funding at \$49,650.

For each year of the program, you will be expected to receive your funding by serving as a teaching and/or research fellow. Your continued eligibility to receive funding is contingent upon your maintaining satisfactory academic progress, as defined by your department and the Questrom School of Business, and the continued availability of funds.

Your funding is based on a full calendar year, thus during the summer you are expected to be in residence, holding a service position, and pursuing a supervised research agenda while preparing for your semesterly assignments. Working with faculty as a research and teaching fellow is an integral part of your doctoral experience and will provide you with an opportunity to quickly gain first-hand experience.

The purpose of fully supporting our graduate students is to allow them to engage wholly in their scholarly work and to devote the attention necessary to complete their studies in a timely fashion. For this reason, we expect students holding service positions to devote no more than 20 hours per week to their assigned activity.

Please note that research, teaching, and instructional positions are covered by a Collective Bargaining Agreement negotiated between Boston University and the Boston University Graduate Workers' Union (BUGWU)/Service Employees International Union (SEIU), Local 509. All new employees in a position represented by BUGWU are required to either (1) become a Union member and pay dues, via payroll deductions by the 30th calendar day following employment, or (2) pay an agency fee to the Union without becoming a member.

The BUGWU Collective Bargaining Agreement sets forth some of your rights and responsibilities as a member of this bargaining unit. You may access the BUGWU Collective Bargaining Agreement at <http://www.seiu509.org/members/higher-education/>.

Benefits

Students receiving full funding also receive many other benefits, including but not limited to the following:

- a full tuition scholarship;

- payment of mandatory student fees;
- payment of the premium for BU's student health insurance plan
- An annual dental health insurance subsidy;
- access to paid parental leave;
- childcare subsidies for students within an income threshold;
- commuting benefits (MBTA pass discount or bicycle reimbursement);
- access to a graduate student help fund.

Graduate students must be eligible to work in the United States to receive their stipend. We are bound by the residency and visa requirements of the United States government, so stipend payments to international students are contingent on those students obtaining an appropriate student visa and legally entering the United States.

Tax Information

The University is providing you with tuition and student fees as a qualified scholarship, as defined in 26 USC Section 117(a) of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code. It is not contingent upon your appointment as a teaching or research fellow and is not taxable to you as the recipient. Your stipend will be taxable as wages, and you will receive a W-2 reflecting your stipend. You are responsible for any tax consequences, as applicable.

Corresponding Duties & Responsibilities

The doctoral program is designed to help students learn both the science and art of research and teaching. Active involvement with faculty acting as mentors in both research and teaching is a critical part of the doctoral experience, designed to complement and add to what is covered in the course work. During your doctoral course of study, students working with their respective department doctoral liaison and advisors will structure a set of activities that ensure that students achieve their goals.

All PhD students, as part of their funding package, must serve as a research or teaching fellow each semester. During the third or fourth year, students are expected to teach one course. At the discretion of the department, and in order to enhance your professional academic credentials, you may be asked to teach a second course. During the semester(s) you are teaching your own course, no additional RF/TF work will be required of you.

PhD students may not accept additional paid employment during the years they are receiving a PhD in Business Economics stipend without prior approval from their department and the PhD in Business Economics Faculty Director.

All scholarships and funding support are contingent upon the student's progress and academic standing in the program. Maintenance of at least a 3.30 cumulative grade point average in major courses and a 3.30 cumulative grade point average in all courses constitutes good academic standing. Failure to remain in good academic standing, or to satisfactorily perform the teaching and research requirements as determined by the department, will lead to the termination of funding support with no option for renewal.

Ph.D. students who withdraw upon matriculation to the Ph.D. program will forfeit their scholarship and funding for use in current or future semesters. Ph.D. students who take a personal leave of absence prior to the start of the semester will have their scholarship and funding support canceled, which will also result in the cancellation of medical insurance credits. Ph.D. students who take a personal leave of absence after the start of the semester will have their scholarship and funding support canceled, which may result in the cancellation of medical insurance credits, and students will be responsible for the portion of their tuition stipulated by the University Refund Schedule.

This package does not provide financial support for recipients after Year 5. However, students who are working on dissertations may apply for funding from sources such as faculty grants, research centers, and research institutes at Boston University.